

ADVERTISEMENT

Security built to secure — not to tax
Help analysts finally fight the adversary, not the toolset.



THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp. * * * * * MONDAY, MARCH 23, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVII NO. 67 WSJ.com ★★★★★ \$5.00

Last week: DJIA 45577.47 ▼ 981.00 2.11% NASDAQ 21647.61 ▼ 2.1% STOXX 600 573.28 ▼ 3.8% 10-YR. TREASURY ▼ 27/32, yield 4.390% OIL \$98.32 ▼ \$0.39 EURO \$1.1572 YEN 159.23

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Kevin Warsh**, Trump's choice to be the next Federal Reserve chair, faces one of the most awkward leadership transitions at the central bank in decades. **A1**
- ◆ **South Korea's president** named Shin Hyun-song, a senior Bank for International Settlements official, as the country's next central-bank governor. **A10**
- ◆ **Major international** stock benchmarks have fallen hard since the start of the conflict in the Middle East, while U.S. indexes have experienced milder losses. **B1**
- ◆ **Elliott has made** a multi-billion-dollar investment in Synopsys and intends to engage the chip-design software maker to improve financial performance. **B1**
- ◆ **Elon Musk said** Tesla and SpaceX would together build a huge chip factory in Austin, Texas, to support his plans for AI, robots and human settlements in space. **B1**
- ◆ **Nevada won** a temporary restraining order to prevent Kashi from offering event-based contracts related to sports, elections and entertainment. **B3**
- ◆ **Amazon's "Project Hail Mary"** adventure movie starring Ryan Gosling opened as a hit, with an estimated \$80.5 million box office in the U.S. and Canada. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Iran said it would** target critical infrastructure if Trump fulfilled his weekend threat to "obliterate" the nation's power plants should Tehran fail to reopen the Strait of Hormuz within days. **A1, A6, A8**
- ◆ **ICE officers will begin** trying to ease bottlenecks at airports as the Trump administration scrambles to develop a plan to end long security lines amid the partial government shutdown. **A3**
- ◆ **Health Secretary** Robert F. Kennedy Jr. wants to make it easier for consumers to buy peptides, unevenly regulated drugs largely made in China that are reputed to improve well-being. **A3**
- ◆ **Hawaii officials urged** people in hard-hit areas to evacuate as the state was hit with its worst flooding in more than 20 years. **A3**
- ◆ **The White House** released legislative recommendations to shape AI policy, outlining a framework favoring light-touch regulation over comprehensive state-level laws. **A4**
- ◆ **Nice became the** largest city in France to be governed by the far right when Eric Ciotti won an election for mayor in a runoff. **A10**
- ◆ **Died: Robert Mueller**, 81, led FBI, investigation into Russian election interference. **A4**

JOURNAL REPORT

Artificial Intelligence:
The danger of AI
sycophancy. **R1-6**

CONTENTS	Market Data..... B7
Arts in Review..... A13	Opinion..... A15-17
Box Office..... B3	Personal Journal A11-12
Business & Finance..... B2-3	Sports..... A14
Capital Account..... A2	Technology..... B4
Crossword..... A12	U.S. News..... A2-5
Heard on Street..... B9	World News..... A6-10



© 2026 Dow Jones & Company, Inc.
All Rights Reserved

Iran's Strikes Are Costing Big Oil Trump, Tehran Exchange Threats

Damage to Mideast energy sites disrupts production and will require major repairs

By COLLIN EATON
AND MATTHEW DALTON

When Iranian missiles struck the Pearl gas-to-liquids facility in Qatar, they knocked out one of Shell's crown jew-

els, a giant plant that is among the most sophisticated and profitable businesses in the company's sprawling global operations.

The plant was so heavily damaged that one of its two production lines is expected to be shut for at least a year, Qatar said.

Some of the Western oil industry's most important investments have become targets for Iran in its war with

War Reverberates

- ◆ Mideast flights go on in the face of risks..... A6
- ◆ South Korea confronts the shift in U.S. focus..... A8
- ◆ Turkish border crossing becomes a lifeline..... A8

one-fifth of its oil-and-gas production from the Middle East, analysts estimate.

Chevron operates big gas assets off the coast of Israel that it has shut off, while ConocoPhillips has stakes in Qatari gas production. About 17% of TotalEnergies' annual operating income comes from oil and gas stuck behind the Strait of Hormuz, the narrow waterway that connects the

Please turn to page A6

Iran to hit interests in region if plants are struck after president demands open strait

Iran said it would target critical infrastructure if President Trump follows through on his weekend threat to "obliterate" the nation's power plants if Tehran didn't reopen the Strait of Hormuz within days.

By Alyssa Lukpat,
Summer Saud
and Benoit Facon

The escalating rhetoric set off alarm bells across the Middle East, with oil-exporting Gulf countries saying that Iranian reprisals could further endanger the world economy.

The U.S. president's threat came in a Saturday evening social-media post.

"If Iran doesn't FULLY OPEN, WITHOUT THREAT, the Strait of Hormuz, within 48 HOURS from this exact point in time, the United States of America will hit and obliterate their various POWER PLANTS, STARTING WITH THE BIGGEST ONE FIRST!" Trump posted.

Tehran said it would respond in kind to any attack on its critical infrastructure. Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi posted on X that

Please turn to page A8

ICE Gets New Role as Airport Security Lines Grow



HOLDING PATTERN: New York City's JFK Airport saw long lines Sunday for TSA passenger checks. The Trump administration plans to bring in Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers to ease bottlenecks amid a partial Homeland Security shutdown. **A3**

The Cutthroat Tactics Of an Antitrust Fixer

Mike Davis went over DOJ officials' heads to get deals approved

Gail Slater, then-head of the Justice Department's antitrust division, was reviewing Hewlett Packard Enter-

By Dana Mattioli,
Rebecca Ballhaus
and Josh Dawsey

prise's \$14 billion bid to acquire rival Juniper when she got a call from one of the

company's outside lawyers.

"If you don't approve this settlement, I will destroy you. I will destroy your job at the DOJ," Mike Davis told her, according to a sworn deposition by her former deputy, Roger Alford, reviewed by The Wall Street Journal.

Slater relayed the call to Alford and told him it had

Please turn to page A10

INSIDE



SPORTS

In a span of three days, Nebraska nabs its first two wins, ever, in the NCAA tournament. **A14**

Fed Leadership Faces Awkward Transition

By NICK TIMIRAOS

Kevin Warsh is facing one of the most awkward Federal Reserve leadership transitions in decades.

The economy has grown more complicated than when he promised interest-rate cuts last year while campaigning for President Trump to nominate him for the job. Even before the war in Iran sent energy prices higher, the Fed's preferred inflation measure was heading in the wrong di-

rection. The war threatens to push inflation higher still in the coming months, and investors now view rate increases to be more likely than cuts this year.

The confirmation process, meanwhile, has stalled, making it hard to say whether Warsh will take over when Fed Chair Jerome Powell's term ends in two months.

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Greg Ip: Fed's next rate move could be a hike A2**

French Show Makes Its Guests Glow

Americans obsess over 'good lighting' on 'Quotidien'

By ASHLEY WONG

Everyone knows that Margot Robbie is beautiful. But when she appears on "Quotidien," something magical happens. Her skin glows, her eyes sparkle and her hair shines.

This is the power of "the French show with the good lighting."

"Quotidien" is like an evening version of "The View" for French people—a 90-minute program that mixes news analysis and interviews with politicians and celebrities promoting new projects. But on the internet, it's the TV show where the world's most attractive people somehow look even better, de-

Please turn to page A12

Young Workers Find Ways To AI-Proof Their Careers

By RACHEL WOLFE
AND TE-PING CHEN

Jackson Curtis planned to spend his career in insurance, where he has worked for the past 3½ years. Instead, the 28-year-old is now pursuing an abrupt shift: becoming a full-time firefighter.

Curtis, who lives outside Tacoma, Wash., fears that artificial intelligence is coming for his office job, which mostly involves data entry. And he thinks rising up the career ladder would still leave him vulnerable.

"Even if they can come up with a way to utilize AI to fight fires, people are always going to want that empathy from an actual human who actually cares during a moment of crisis," Curtis said.

AI's workplace impact, including its potential to help careers, remains more the subject of economics papers than hard evidence. But young people, especially those just

launching into long working lives ahead of them, are starting to navigate their future career choices with AI in mind.

Some are pivoting to blue-collar work or starting their own businesses that may insulate them from the impacts of AI. Others are actively embracing it to try to take advantage of an AI boom and stay ahead of the curve.

"Students definitely know it's going to have an impact, it's just not clear how much of one or what it looks like," said Stacie Gleason, a high-school counselor in Hoboken, N.J. She said she has daily conversations with seniors who are wondering how AI might affect them.

A recent Harvard University survey of Americans between ages 18 and 29 showed that 59% said they saw AI as a threat to their job prospects, with college graduates in particular sharing such concerns.

Please turn to page A5

100[★]
hours saved
monthly

Elastic Security
helps Texas A&M
secure systems
with automation,
not overtime.

